

Google Analytics for Android gets an update

Google Analytics
Anywhere. Anytime.



If you have been checking the performance of your site on the mobile via Google Analytics, don't be surprised if the next time you log in, you are welcomed to a new card-based interface. Google is updating Google Analytics for Android.

This new look is not the only part of this update. Google has also introduced a range of new features based on the feedback it received from 700,000 users who are using it already. Google Analytics for Android will now have a standard slide-out side navigation bar. New visualisations of the statistics will automatically resize to fit your screen. This is especially beneficial for those with a small screen, as now all the relevant metrics will spread out over multiple cards.

As for features, the app now puts a stronger emphasis on real-time data, a feature Analytics first introduced in 2011 but only really started to emphasise over the last few months, reports Tech Crunch. Additionally, it now also supports Analytics' Advanced Segments for isolating and analysing specific types of traffic. Google wrote, "You can keep track of all of your important data with reports that are optimised for whatever device you're using, ensuring a beautiful and intuitive experience." Developers can also tweak the installed app without making users download a new version of the app. This will help in quickly adding new reports and visualisations to the app without having to update it.

Google's Chromebook 11 unveiled!

Google has unveiled its new Chromebook laptop, which has features similar to high-end laptops but is priced at only US\$ 279. Built by Hewlett-Packard (HP), the HP Chromebook 11 has features that are usually seen in laptops worth US\$ 1,000. In fact, the new device that has the Chrome OS sports many features from other laptops running Google's Chrome OS, like the Chromebook Pixel, which costs US\$ 1,299.



The newly unveiled Chromebook 11 laptop has a plastic frame with no sharp edges or corners. In fact, even screw holes are missing, which gives it a very sleek look. Further, the device's speakers are placed under its keyboard, which means that the sound is directed towards the user.

The 29.26-cm (11.6-inch) laptop weighs only 1.04 kg (2.3 lb) and is apparently based on the Chromebook Pixel, which was designed by Google itself. But the two companies did have to make a few sacrifices in order to keep the price as low as US\$ 279. For one, the device does not have a touchscreen display and neither is the display as sharp as the Chromebook Pixel. Further, the metal frame is replaced by plastic and the laptop has only 16 GB of storage in the basic model.

Interestingly, the Chromebook 11 is charged via a micro-USB port, which is the same as those used in smartphones and tablets.

Google's KitKat to take on popular chatting apps

Among the popular chatting apps, WhatsApp, Kik and Line have made a big impact on the mobile app stores globally. They offer a sturdy chat ecosystem in comparison to Apple or Google and have been able to do it by themselves.

According to sources, Google has completely shifted from Google Chat to Hangouts on the desktop. Google also plans to launch the enhanced software to its mobile platform in a much better manner.

The Android Police have been handed with alleged screenshots of Android 4.4 KitKat displaying settings, which will allow SMS and MMS with Hangouts. Even though there is no solid evidence to show that the messaging app is going to be done with, the concept of mixing the popular Hangouts chat service along with existing mobile messaging services is a great way to compete with third-party apps.



Linux professionals very much in demand!

The demand for professionals trained in open source and Linux has been rising for some time now. An analysis by LinuxCareer.com shows how the demand for employees with skills in different open source software is increasing. The IT Skills Watch report published by LinuxCareer.com has a breakdown of how the demand for skilled workers is divided between platforms such as PHP, Apache Tomcat, etc.

The report states that the demand for open source employees with skills in PHP, SQL, Ruby on Rails and development tools is high. The report is based on data collected from different companies or employers.

The Linux Foundation survey on the same topic showed that 93 per cent of the employers want to hire at least one Linux-skilled professional. Further, there has been a 9 per cent rise in the pay of such employees from January 2012 to this year.